

Run it 24/7 on an MQL5 VPS

Move MT5 and TheConnector's robot off your laptop onto MetaQuotes' own server in London. TradingView's alerts are then traded at FxPro with your laptop switched off.

STRATEGY

SMC_Structure_Strategy_v8.3.txt

BROKER

FxPro MT5

COST

about 15 USD a month per trading account

BRIDGE

TheConnector: webhook → robot in MT5

SERVER

MQL5 Virtual Hosting, London

TIME

about 30 minutes, plus a test

Do every step on a DEMO account first and trade it there for two weeks before going live. This guide is not financial advice. Menu names are MT5's; TheConnector's own screens are described by what they are for, because their layout can change.

SECTION 1

How it works

Three pieces make one trade. Two of them already run in the cloud; only MT5 has to leave your laptop.

	Piece	Where it runs today	Needs your laptop?
1	The strategy and its alert	TradingView's servers (paid plan)	No
2	TheConnector's webhook receiver	TheConnector's cloud	No
3	MT5 with TheConnector's robot (EA)	Your laptop	Yes - this is the piece we move

The path of one trade

An order of the strategy **fills** in TradingView → the alert sends its message to your webhook URL → TheConnector's cloud receives it → the robot inside MT5 picks it up → the order is placed at FxPro, with its own stop, target and tag. After this guide, the robot and MT5 run on the VPS instead of your laptop. Nothing changes in the strategy or in the alert.

What the MQL5 VPS is

MetaQuotes' own server that runs a copy of your MT5 day and night, a few milliseconds from FxPro's servers in London. You rent it from inside MT5.

Plan	Price (check the one MT5 shows you)
1 month	about 15 USD
3 months	about 14 USD a month
12 months	about 12.80 USD a month
Free trial	sometimes 24 hours, when MT5 offers it - use it for the first test

What it cannot do

- One subscription covers **one trading account**. A demo and a live account need one each.
- It runs Expert Advisors only - no DLL files. TheConnector's robot talks to TheConnector through MT5's normal web requests, which the VPS supports; the test in Part D proves it on your account.
- You cannot open its screen. You see its log, and your trades in any MT5 logged in to the same account (laptop or phone).
- An account that asks for a one-time password at every login cannot be used.

SECTION 2

Before you start, and Part A

Tick every box, then prepare MT5 on your laptop. Parts A, B and C can be done in one sitting of about 30 minutes.

Before you start - tick every box

You need	
☐	A paid TradingView plan (Essential or above). Webhook alerts do not exist on the free plan.
☐	An FxPro MT5 demo account : login number, main (trading) password - not the investor password, which cannot trade - and the server name exactly as MT5 shows it.
☐	A free account at mql5.com . The VPS is rented through it.
☐	TheConnector : your account, its robot installed in MT5 on the laptop, and the robot's codes from TheConnector's dashboard.
☐	A payment method for mql5.com.
☐	The strategy's alert already made: condition Order fills only , message only <code>{{strategy.order.alert_message}}</code> , webhook URL <code>https://webhook.theconnector.fr/YOUR_ACCESS_KEY</code> .

Keep these private

Your TheConnector access key, the robot's codes and your MT5 password. Never paste them into a chat, an e-mail or a screenshot. The access key belongs only at the end of the webhook URL, inside TradingView.

Part A - prepare MT5 on your laptop (once)

- 1 **Log in** to the FxPro MT5 account you will automate, with the **main** password. Tick **Save password**.
- 2 **Tools** → **Options** → **Community**: log in with your mql5.com account.
- 3 **Tools** → **Options** → **Expert Advisors**:
 - tick **Allow algorithmic trading**;
 - tick **Allow WebRequest for listed URL** and add TheConnector's address exactly as TheConnector's MT5 guide gives it;
 - leave **Allow DLL imports OFF** - the VPS does not allow it.
- 4 **Tidy MT5**: close every chart except ONE (for example XAUUSD M1). In Market Watch keep only the symbols you trade: right-click → Hide all, then add your symbols back (gold, and any forex pairs you will trade).
- 5 **Attach the robot**: drag TheConnector's EA onto that one chart. In its inputs type the codes from TheConnector's dashboard. On the **Common** tab tick **Allow Algo Trading**. Click OK.
- 6 **Check it on the laptop first**: the **Experts** tab (Toolbox at the bottom) shows the robot loaded with no errors, and TheConnector's dashboard shows the robot **connected**. Do not continue until both are true.

Move MT5 to the VPS

Part B rents the server and copies MT5 onto it; Part C, right after it, prevents double trades.

Part B - rent the VPS and move MT5 onto it

- 7 **Navigator** → **Accounts** → right-click your FxPro account → **Register a Virtual Server** (or the VPS button in the toolbar).
- 8 MT5 picks the server closest to FxPro and shows how much faster it is than your own connection. FxPro's servers are in London, so expect a **London** server and a ping of a few milliseconds.
- 9 Choose the **free trial** if it is offered, otherwise **one month**. Take a longer plan only after the test in Part D has passed.
- 10 Pay, then choose the migration type **Experts** (Expert Advisors and indicators) and click **Migrate**. What moves across: your account login, the chart, the robot with its inputs, the Market Watch symbols and the WebRequest address list. On the VPS, algorithmic trading is always on.

Part C - right after migrating

- 11 **On the laptop, switch the Algo Trading button OFF** (toolbar). If it stays on, the robot runs in two places at once and every trade can be placed twice. With it off you may keep MT5 open on the laptop just to watch, or close it.
- 12 **Read the VPS log:** Navigator → right-click the virtual server → **Journal** (the Toolbox also has a VPS tab). You want: the migration finished, and TheConnector's robot loaded with no errors.
Error 4014 on a web request = TheConnector's address is missing from the WebRequest list. Add it on the laptop (step 3) and migrate again (step 10).
- 13 **TheConnector's dashboard** shows the robot connected again - now from the VPS.

The real test, then going live

Part D proves the VPS trades with your laptop switched off. Only after it passes: two weeks on demo, then the live account.

Part D - the real test, laptop OFF, demo account

- 14 **Shut the laptop down completely.** Use your phone or another computer for the rest.
- 15 In TradingView create **one temporary test alert** on any symbol, with a condition that fires within minutes (for example price crossing a level just above the current price). Webhook URL: `https://webhook.theconnector.fr/YOUR_ACCESS_KEY`. Message, typed by hand for this test only: `{"action":"buy","symbol":"XAUUSD","volume":0.01,"tag":"smcgold"}` (use your MT5 gold symbol name if it is not exactly XAUUSD).
- 16 When it fires, open **MT5 on your phone**: a **0.01-lot buy** must appear on the **demo** account. Close it from the phone - or with a second test alert whose message is `{"action":"closeLong","symbol":"XAUUSD","tag":"smcgold"}`.
- 17 **Delete every test alert.** A hand-typed message is only for this test. The strategy's own alert keeps the message only `{{strategy.order.alert_message}}` and the condition **Order fills only**.
- 18 The trade appeared with the laptop off: **the VPS works**. Now take the longer plan if you want it. If no trade appeared, go to Section 6 - Troubleshooting.

Then: two weeks on demo

Let the strategy's own alert trade the demo account through the VPS for two weeks. Compare FxPro's history with TradingView's List of Trades: the same trades, the same sizes, each closed by its own stop, target or close.

Going live

- 1 Log in to your **live** FxPro MT5 account on the laptop and repeat **Part A** for it (robot on one chart, WebRequest address, Save password).
- 2 Connect the live account in TheConnector as their guide describes, and put the live account's codes into the robot.
- 3 **Register a virtual server for the live account** (Part B) - it needs its own subscription - and migrate.
- 4 **Part C again:** Algo Trading OFF on the laptop, check the VPS Journal, check the dashboard shows connected.
- 5 Cancel the demo VPS when you no longer need it (mql5.com → your profile → Hosting).
- 6 On the first live trade, check the lot size in MT5 yourself.

SECTION 5

Keeping it running

What to do when you change something, and what to check every week.

When you change something later

You change	What to do
Anything inside MT5: robot inputs, a new robot version, a new symbol or chart	Change it on the laptop. Switch Algo Trading ON only while you check it, OFF again, then right-click the virtual server → Migrate again. The VPS copy is replaced by the laptop's.
Add a forex pair	Add it to Market Watch on the laptop and migrate again. Normally the one robot on one chart trades every symbol in Market Watch - confirm it in TheConnector's MT5 guide. Set up the pair's TradingView chart with the forex settings guide.
Strategy settings in TradingView	The VPS is not involved. Delete the strategy's alert and create it again - an alert keeps the settings it was created with.

Every week - two minutes

Check	Where
The VPS is running and the robot loaded without errors	MT5 → Navigator → right-click the virtual server → Journal
The robot is connected	TheConnector's dashboard
FxPro's trades match TradingView's List of Trades	MT5 History (phone is fine) and TradingView's Strategy Tester
The subscription is not about to end	mql5.com → your profile → Hosting: end date and auto-renewal. When it ends, trading stops without a warning.
The TradingView alert is still active	TradingView → Alerts: status and expiry date

Troubleshooting, the fallback, and the rules

What to look at when something does not trade, and what to use if the MQL5 VPS will not run the robot.

What you see	Most likely cause	Fix
The alert fired but no trade at FxPro	Robot not connected; wrong webhook URL; symbol name different at FxPro	Check TheConnector's dashboard and its log; check the URL ends with your access key; check the symbol in MT5's Market Watch (strategy group 30)
Error 4014 in the VPS Journal	TheConnector's address is not in the WebRequest list	Add it on the laptop (step 3), migrate again (step 10)
Every trade opens twice	Algo Trading still ON on the laptop, or the robot on two charts	Algo Trading OFF on the laptop; robot on ONE chart; migrate again
Wrong lot size	Strategy group 22 'Quantity to send' not on Lots, or a wrong contract size	'Quantity to send' = Lots; table row 'Ticker - type / 1 lot / symbol sent'
Trading stopped by itself	VPS subscription ended; TradingView alert expired or was stopped after an edit	Renew the VPS; recreate the alert
The alert never fires	Free TradingView plan, or the alert was made before the last settings change	Paid plan; delete and recreate the alert

If the MQL5 VPS will not run TheConnector's robot

Use an ordinary **Windows VPS in London** and install MT5 yourself, exactly as on your laptop, and leave it running. Examples: Azure (UK South region; a free first year has been offered to new accounts), Contabo (about 10 USD a month), or FxPro's own VPS (about 30 USD a month; FxPro has offered it free to clients who meet its conditions - ask FxPro). On your own Windows VPS:

- connect with Remote Desktop, install MT5, log in, and do **Part A**;
- put an MT5 shortcut in the Windows **Startup** folder (press Win+R, type `shell:startup`) so MT5 comes back after a restart;
- set Windows never to sleep; then do **Part C** (Algo Trading OFF on the laptop) and **Part D** (the test).

The rules that never change

- The strategy's alert: condition **Order fills only**, message only `{{strategy.order.alert_message}}`.
- Webhook URL `https://webhook.theconnector.fr/YOUR_ACCESS_KEY` - your access key only there, never in a chat.
- Never paste TheConnector dashboard's sample message into the strategy's alert. Hand-typed messages are only for the temporary test alerts of Part D - delete them afterwards.
- Replace the strategy's code only while you have no open trade, then recreate the alert.
- Algo Trading ON in one place only: the VPS.